

User Guide for Community Safety Volunteers

Who this guide is for

This guide is for people using the Volunteer Fire Brigade prototype during a community emergency response scenario. It explains what to tap, what each screen means, and how to choose the correct action in the app.

The guide is split into two parts:

- Civilian users — people who need to send an emergency request.
- Responders — volunteer fire brigade members who review and manage active incidents.

If you are requesting help, follow the Civilian Guide. If you are responding to incidents, skip to the Responder Guide.

Civilian Guide: Send an Emergency Request

Use this flow when you need to request help quickly.

Step 1 — Choose the Civilian role

Open the app and select **Civilian**.

What this does:

This takes you to the emergency request screen.

Step 2 — Tap SEND HELP

On the emergency request screen, tap **SEND HELP**.

What this does:

The app starts the emergency reporting process and moves to the confirmation screen.

Step 3 — Check your location and select incident type

On the confirmation screen:

1. Check that your current location is displayed.
2. Select the incident type that best matches the situation.
3. Tap **Confirm**.

What this does:

The app saves the emergency request and sends it to the responder queue.

Step 4 — Stay on the status screen

After submitting the request, the app shows the emergency status screen.

You should:

- stay calm
- move away from danger if possible
- follow the safety guidance shown on the screen
- keep your phone nearby for updates

Responder Guide

1. Sign Up and Log In

Use this flow when you are acting as a volunteer responder.

Step 1 — Choose the Responder role

Open the app and select **Responder**.

What this does:

This takes you to the responder login screen.

Step 2 — Sign up if you do not have an account

If you are using the prototype for the first time, tap **Sign Up** and enter the required details.

You will need to enter:

- username
- email
- password
- first name
- station name

After signing up, return to the login screen.

Step 3 — Log in

Enter your username and password, then tap **Login**.

What this does:

If the details are correct, the app opens the active incident queue.

2. Review Active Incidents

After logging in, responders will see the active incident queue.

Each incident card shows:

- incident ID
- current status
- last updated time
- **View** button

Tap **View** to open the incident details.

Understanding Incident Status

Status	What it means for responders
New	The incident is waiting for responder action. Open it and review the details.
On the Way	A responder has already accepted it or requested support. It can still be tracked.
Done	The incident has been completed and should no longer appear in the active queue.
False Report	The incident has been judged invalid and removed from the active queue.

3. Review Incident Details

After opening an incident, check the details before choosing an action.

Check:

- incident type;
- location;
- GPS status;
- number of reports from the same reporter.

These details help responders decide whether to accept the incident, request support, or flag it as a false report.

4. Which Action Should I Choose?

Use this quick guide before selecting an action.

Situation	Action to choose
The incident looks valid and the team can respond.	Tap Accept / Dispatch .
The incident looks valid but needs extra help.	Tap Request Support .
The incident appears invalid after checking the details.	Tap Flag False Report .
The incident has been handled.	Tap Mark as Done .
The queue looks outdated.	Tap Refresh before choosing an action.

5. Detailed Responder Actions

Action 1 — Accept / Dispatch

Use **Accept / Dispatch** when the incident should be handled by the responder team.

What happens next:

The incident status changes to **On the Way**, and the app opens the dispatch tracking screen.

Action 2 — Request Support

Use **Request Support** when the incident needs extra help or resources.

What happens next:

The incident status changes to **On the Way**, and the dispatch tracking screen shows an additional support warning.

Action 3 — Flag False Report

Use **Flag False Report** only when the incident appears to be invalid after checking the available information.

What happens next:

The incident is marked as **False Report** and removed from the active queue.

6. Track and Complete an Incident

After accepting an incident or requesting support, the app opens the dispatch tracking screen.

The screen may show:

- current status;
- incident type;
- location;
- last updated time;
- estimated time of arrival;
- support warning, if extra support was requested.

When the incident has been handled, tap **Mark as Done**.

What happens next:

The incident is marked as **Done** and removed from the active incident queue.

Field Notes

- Use **Request Support** when extra resources are needed, not as a replacement for **Accept / Dispatch**.
 - Use **Flag False Report** carefully, because it removes the incident from the active queue.
 - **New** and **On the Way** incidents are active incidents.
 - **Done** and **False Report** incidents should no longer appear in the active queue.
 - GPS information may appear as coordinates instead of a street address in this prototype.
 - If the incident queue does not update immediately, tap **Refresh** before taking another action.
 - In a real emergency, users should always follow official emergency procedures and local safety instructions.
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